

Claude Code: One-Page Cheat Sheet

Everything from the course, one page. Keep this open. Stop guessing, start looking it up.

Launching

<code>claude</code>	Start in the current folder (the "job site")
<code>claude --continue</code>	Resume the most recent conversation here
<code>cd <folder> first</code>	Good habit, not a rule. The permission prompt is the real safety net

In-session commands

<code>/help</code>	The always-current manual
<code>/clear</code>	Fresh start. New task means new clear. CLAUDE.md survives.
<code>/compact</code>	Condense a long conversation you're not done with
<code>/model</code>	Switch brains. Escalate for hard or high-stakes tasks.
<code>/init</code>	Generate a CLAUDE.md for a code project
<code>Esc</code>	Interrupt mid-action. Always allowed.
<code>Shift+Tab</code>	Cycle modes: normal, auto-accept, plan mode
<code>/exit</code> or <code>Ctrl+C</code> twice	Exit (your files stay)
<code>#</code> prefix	Save a note to memory for future sessions

The brief (4 parts)

1. **Outcome:** what exists when the work is done
2. **Materials:** where the inputs are
3. **Constraints:** what must and must not happen
4. **Done:** how you'll both know it worked

For anything touching many files, add: "show me a plan and a small sample first."

Phrases that earn their keep

- "Show me a plan before touching anything."
- "What did you change and why?"
- "What could go wrong with this approach?"
- "Write a check that verifies this a different way, and run it."
- "Good, but..." (a targeted correction beats a restart)
- "Stop fixing. Diagnose first, then propose, then wait."
- "Add that to CLAUDE.md."
- "Commit this." / "Commit first, then let's try it."
- "Undo the changes since the last commit."
- "Turn this into a script / slash command I can reuse."

Git in English

Say	Get
"Put this project under version control"	git, .gitignore, first commit
"Commit this with a sensible message"	Save-point
"What changed since the last commit?"	Plain-English diff
"Undo changes to X, keep the rest"	Single-file restore
"Roll back to how it was Tuesday"	Time travel
"Create a private GitHub repo and push"	Off-machine backup

Safety defaults (non-negotiable)

- New tool or new territory: sandbox folder first
- Many files: sample before the full run
- Say "don't delete anything" and "never overwrite originals" explicitly
- Money, legal, or outbound email: independent verification, every time
- Loosen permissions in proportion to your undo ability. Git-tracked folder, relax. Unversioned originals, keep the prompts.

When stuck

1. Say specifically what's wrong, with an example
2. Separate diagnosis from action ("explain first, don't fix yet")
3. Undo, then `/clear`, then re-brief with what you learned
4. Escalate the model (`/model`) for genuinely hard problems

Is this a Claude Code task?

Repetitive across many items. Format-shifting. Rule-based tedium. Many sources into one document. Anything you'd do if it took 5 minutes but skip because it takes an hour. If you nodded at any of those, stop reading and go delegate it.